Engelbart - Mathetic PBC

A research notebook that remembers where your thoughts came from.

The problem

Researchers think across a dozen tools: papers in a reference manager, drafts in Overleaf and Docs, ideas in chats with AI assistants, decisions in Slack and meetings. Notes record ideas but not their sources. Two weeks later, about a third of a researcher's notes can no longer be traced to where they came from, and AI chats are the hardest to recover.

What Engelbart does

• Imports a researcher's existing tools in one step -- chats, files, papers, repos, notes, email and drive -- and groups them by project.

• Keeps provenance: every thought on the canvas links back to the chat, paper or conversation it came from.

• Deduplicates without losing history: the same paper from Zotero and Downloads becomes one entry; drafts stay as versions.

• Answers "where did this come from?" for any claim in a draft.

Why now

AI assistants have multiplied the volume of research thinking that happens in chat. None of it is connected to the rest of a researcher's work. Export formats are finally rich enough to import it.

Who it is for, and who pays

PhD students and postdocs first, then research labs, then R&D teams in industry. Individuals pay a monthly subscription; labs pay per seat with shared projects. Retention target for pilots: weekly use in 6 of the first 8 weeks.

Traction

Working canvas prototype; import from 10+ sources; pilot onboarding sessions with researchers at UC Berkeley and CMU scheduled for October 2026.

Team

David Barron (CEO) -- HCI PhD student at Virginia Tech (on leave). Hudson Mitchell-Pullman (co-founder) -- product, design and go-to-market. Based at the Surplus incubator, San Francisco.

Public benefit

Mathetic is a Delaware public benefit corporation. Our purpose: to help people learn and think more clearly by keeping the record of how their ideas formed in their own hands.

The ask

Raising a pre-seed round on a SAFE to fund 12 months of product work and pilots.